

Human-Computer Interaction (CSCE 378, Sec. 001)
MWF 3:30 PM - 4:20 PM, Room: Louise Pound Hall 102

Instructor: Alisha Bevins

Instructor Contact: abevins2@unl.edu

Office Hours: Wed/Fri from 2:00 PM- 3:00 PM in KAUF 135 and by appointment

Teaching Assistant: Fatemeh Raei Dehaghi

TA Contact: fraeidehaghi2@huskers.unl.edu

TA Office Hours: Wed from 9:00 AM - 10:00 AM in Avery 103H

Required Materials: There are no required materials for this course. There are supplementary readings available on Canvas, and optional readings will come from the course text : Interaction Design by Sharp, Rogers, Preece, Wiley, 6th edition, 2023, ISBN-10: 1119901099

Additional readings may be posted to Canvas with prior notice.

Attendance Policy: Make-ups for assignments and projects will be given only under circumstances beyond student's control (a university sanctioned excuse). Prior arrangements with the instructor must be made when feasible and official verification of circumstances necessitating the absence may be requested. Certain classes are required for the project portion of the grade, and are bolded on the course plan uploaded to Canvas.

Additionally, it is CSE Department policy that students in CSE courses regularly (every 24 hours) check their email so that they do not miss important course announcements.

Grade Policy:

Project	60%
Lecture/Reading Quizzes	15%
Class Participation	15%
HFS/Dark Patterns Presentation	10%

Course Objectives: By the end of the course, the student should be able to:

- Identify and define the usability goals for a software application and specify how these can be measured.
- Apply knowledge of human cognition and performance to explain how humans succeed and fail to interact with software systems.
- Build low, medium, and high-fidelity prototypes and mockups, as well as understand their role in the development process.
- Design and run user studies to evaluate interfaces by observing how intended users interact with them using methods such as performance testing and talk-aloud.
- Perform qualitative evaluation of interfaces that do not involve users, such as heuristic evaluations or cognitive walkthroughs.

Grading: Will be based on the following scale:

A+: 97- 100.0	A: 93 - 96.99	A-: 90 - 92.99
B+: 87 - 89.99	B: 83 - 86.99	B-: 80 - 82.99
C+: 77 - 79.99	C: 73 - 76.99	C-: 70 - 72.99

D+: 67 - 69.99 **D:** 63 - 66.99 **D-:** 60 - 62.99
F: 0 - 59.99

Assignments: Assignments will be due via Canvas by 11:59 PM on the due date, unless otherwise specified.

Project: Each student will complete a team project (4-5 members) to demonstrate an understanding of the material covered in class.

The project will consist of eight portions (total 100 pts):

- Project Team Formation (2.5 pts): Document presenting the strengths, weaknesses, and common interests of a proposed team.
- Project Proposal (10 points): Defines the problem, analyzes the problem, identifies current solutions, and provides proposed benefits of a new solution.
- Requirements Gathering (10 points): Proposes users of the system, summarizes interviews from prospective users, performs a task analysis of the proposed system, and analyzes the potential impact of adoption.
- Prototyping (27.5 points): A paper prototype with report (10 pts) and in-class testing (2.5 pts), computer prototype with report (10 pts), and presentation (5 pts) explaining your process and testing will be submitted.
- Cognitive Walkthrough (5 points): An in-class session will be conducted for groups to critique each others' work.
- Usability Testing (10 points): A usability test plan will be submitted (and feedback provided), then usability testing will be conducted with users who have not previously commented on any of the design steps. The test plan will include a hypothesis, participants, experimental design, data collection and analysis techniques, and any scripts to be used.
- Final Report (25 points): An IEEE-style paper on the entire project.
- Final presentation (10 points): Presentations of project materials throughout the term.

The iterative design will generate feedback from the instructor, your course-mates, and potential users of the system. At each deliverable, feedback from these groups should be summarized and your team should address how feedback was included, as well as why other feedback was not addressed.

Tentative Project Due Dates:

Project Teams	August 30
Project Proposal	September 6
Requirements Gathering	September 16
Prototyping	Sept 20, Oct 7, Oct 14, Oct 23
Cognitive Walkthrough	Oct 28, Oct 30, Nov 1
Usability Test Plan	November 11
Final Presentations	December 6 - 13
Final Report	December 9

Group Work: Group work is an integral part of this course. To make sure you get to know your group before working on the project you will complete a “contract” with them to make sure you are on the same page about performance expectations in P0.

Once in the middle of the semester and once at the end of the semester all group members will complete a peer and self evaluation. These scores will be averaged. Members who perform poorly at the mid-semester

check will have to briefly meet with the instructor to discuss how they plan to improve. Poor scores at the end of semester evaluation will negatively impact your project grade following this scale:

4 (Exceptional)	No Impact
3 (Average)	No Impact
2 (Does not fully meet expectations)	Final Project Grade * 0.85
1 (Does not meet expectations at all).....	Final Project Grade * 0.60

HFS/Dark Patterns: You will either present an example of a web interface that exhibits a “Dark Pattern” and how this impacts the usability goals, or present an example of a Hall of Fame/Hall of Shame interface. This will involve a 2-2:30 minute presentation in class.

General Policies

Academic Honesty

Academic honesty is essential to the existence and integrity of an academic institution. The responsibility for maintaining that integrity is shared by all members of the academic community. The University’s Student Code of Conduct addresses academic dishonesty. Students who commit acts of academic dishonesty are subject to disciplinary action and are granted due process and the right to appeal any decision.

All homework assignments, quizzes, exams, etc. must be your own work. No direct collaboration with fellow students, past or current, is allowed unless otherwise stated. Since writing, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all writing assignments should be prepared by the student. Developing strong competencies in this area will prepare you for a competitive workplace. While A.I. is readily available and can be useful in some circumstances, it is essential that you learn basic skills to help you identify what good writing looks like before you’ll be able to accurately and ethically employ their use. To better help you meet the learning goals of this course, A.I.-generated submissions are not permitted and will be treated as plagiarism.

The Computer Science & Engineering department has an Academic Integrity Policy (<http://cse.unl.edu/academic-integrity-policy>). All students enrolled in any computer science course are bound by this policy. You are expected to read, understand, and follow this policy. Violations will be dealt with on a case by case basis and may result in a failing assignment or a failing grade for the course itself.

Late Work

Late work will not be accepted unless arrangements are made with the instructor prior to the due date.

Assistance

Please seek assistance immediately if you are having difficulty with the course. Help can only be made available from the instructor if she is notified promptly. Additional help can be requested from the Student Resource Center in Avery 12: <http://cse.unl.edu/src>.

The Writing Center can provide you with meaningful support as you write for this class as well as every course in which you enroll. Trained undergraduate and graduate peer consultants are available to talk with you about all forms of communication. You are welcome to bring in lab reports, presentations, research papers, etc. Writing Center Consultants can work with you at any stage of the writing process, from brainstorming and organizing your ideas through polishing a final draft.

There are three ways you can connect with a Consultant: In Person, Online (a real-time, video conversation), and eTutoring (email feedback). To learn more about online options and view video tutorials, visit <https://www.unl.edu/writing/online-writing-center-services>. In Fall 2024, in-person Writing Center

appointments will take place in Andrews 102. Appointments are up to 40 minutes long. Sign up for an appointment any time by visiting unl.mywconline.com. For other information about the Writing Center, please visit unl.edu/writing.

Students with Disabilities

The University strives to make all learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on your disability (e.g. physical disability, learning disability, ADHD, chronic health issue, mental health condition, complications with a pregnancy, long Covid, temporary injury, or other condition), please let me know immediately so that we can discuss options privately. To establish reasonable accommodations, I may request that you register with Services for Students with Disabilities (SSD). If you are eligible for services and register with their office, make arrangements with me as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so they can be implemented in a timely manner. SSD contact information: 117 Louise Pound Hall.; 402-472-3787.

Concerns

The CSE Department has an anonymous contact form (<http://cse.unl.edu/contact-form>) that you may use to voice your concerns about any problems in the course or department if you do not wish to be identified.

Counseling and Psychological Services

UNL offers a variety of options to students to aid them in dealing with stress and adversity. Counseling and Psychological & Services (CAPS); is a multidisciplinary team of psychologists and counselors that works collaboratively with Nebraska students to help them explore their feelings and thoughts and learn helpful ways to improve their mental, psychological and emotional well-being when issues arise. CAPS can be reached by calling 402-472-7450. Big Red Resilience & Well-Being (BRRWB) provides one-on-one well-being coaching to any student who wants to enhance their well-being. Trained well-being coaches help students create and be grateful for positive experiences, practice resilience and self-compassion, and find support as they need it. BRRWB can be reached by calling 402-472-8770.

Additional university policies can be found at <http://go.unl.edu/coursepolicies>